YOUR MAGAZINE FROM GALLIONS

thamesview

NEWS • EVENTS • COMPETITIONS

JULY 2012
www.gallionsha.co.uk



LOW COST COMPUTERS AND FREE IT TRAINING

START YOUR SUMMER HEALTH KICK NOW

ALL YOU NEED TO KNOW ABOUT BENEFIT CHANGES

Gallions Housing Association

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WITH THIS ISSUE: YOUR FREE REPAIRS & MAINTENANCE GUIDE!

WELCOME

Summer is a great time of year to start thinking about getting outside and getting healthy. This edition of Thamesview is full of ideas to help. Flick through the magazine and you can find out what Trust Thamesmead, Greenwich Healthy Living Service and the Change4Life campaign has to offer. If you don't fancy venturing out into the sunshine (or rain!) you could pick up a refurbished computer for a reduced price and get online instead.

We have also included a Repairs and Maintenance Guide with this issue (tenants only). It explains which repairs are Gallions' responsibility and which repairs our tenants are expected to carry out themselves.

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Gallions Residents Group

Gallions Housing Association

GRAB A LOW COST INTERNET-READY COMPUTER TODAY!

Get Online at Home is a new campaign to help people get their first, internet-ready computer at a price they can afford. The refurbished PCs and laptops come with a 30-day warranty and support, the latest Microsoft® software and free accessibility software.

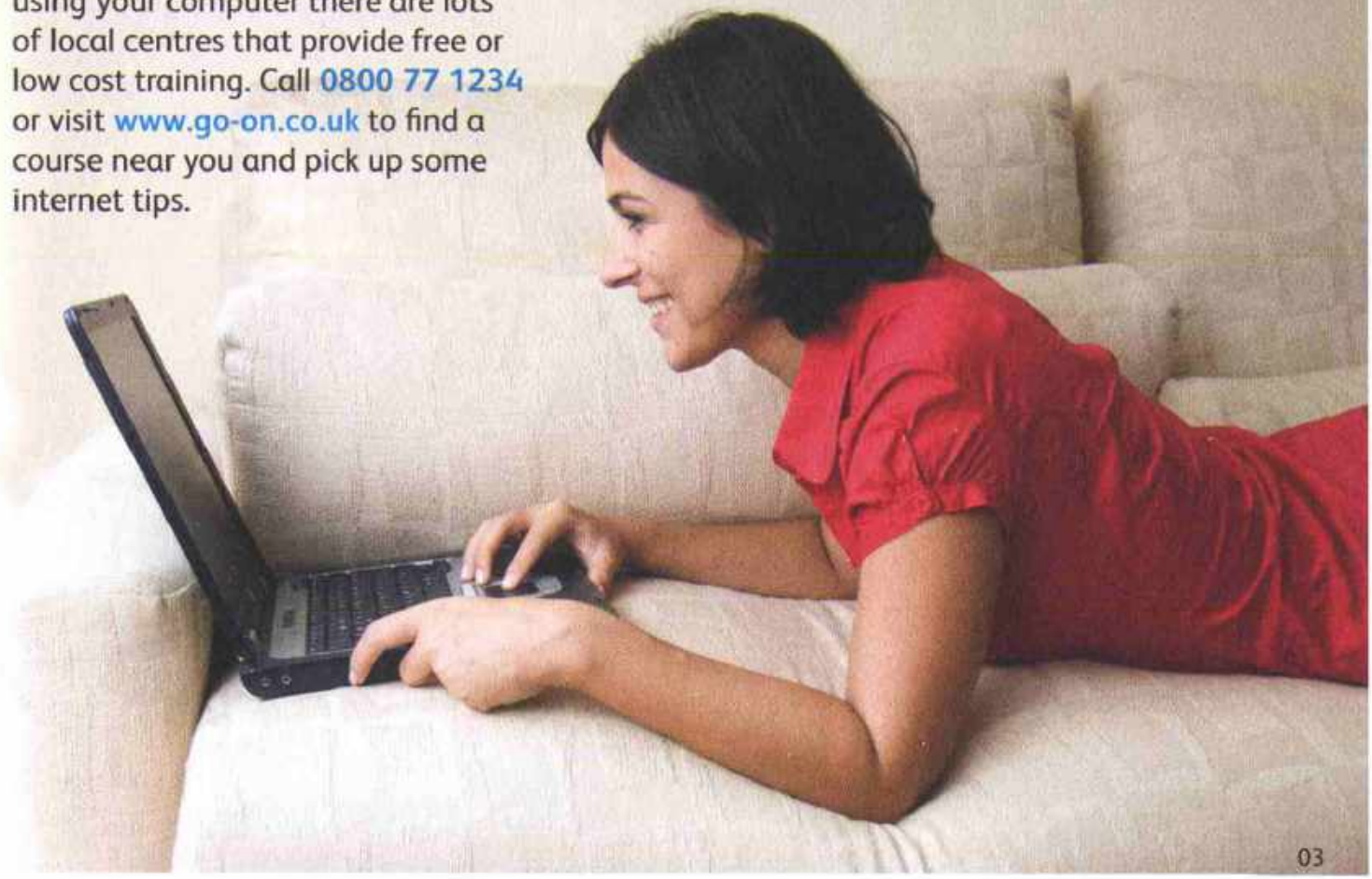
PCs cost £149 and laptops are £199 but there are extra discounts for residents on benefits and for those that sign up to broadband through the scheme.

To find out more call **03719 100 100** or visit **www.getonlineathome.org**.

If you need a hand getting started using your computer there are lots of local centres that provide free or low cost training. Call **0800 77 1234** or visit **www.go-on.co.uk** to find a course near you and pick up some internet tips.



"There are extra discounts for residents on benefits and for those that sign up to broadband through the scheme."



CHANGES TO BENEFITS COULD AFFECT YOU...

From April 2013 there will be some major changes to the benefits system that could affect how much you are entitled to. Take a look at our timetable below to see when the changes will apply.

You need to start planning now to make sure you are able to keep up with your rent and bills when the changes happen. If you are unsure about how the changes could impact on you, contact our Welfare Benefits Team for free advice about:

- Claiming benefits and tax credits
- Budgeting and managing your money
- Accessing free debt advice
- Paying your rent and bills
- Getting a bank account
- Accessing affordable credit

Contact us today on 0300 123 1237 to make an appointment.

April 2013

- Housing Benefit will be reduced for tenants who are under occupying (some exemptions apply):

  14% reduction if under occupying by one bedroom

  25% reduction if under occupying by two or more bedrooms

- A benefits cap will be introduced. This will restrict the total amount of benefit that working age people can receive (some exemptions will apply)

- Introduction of Personal Independence Payment for new claimants of disability benefit

  Existing claimants of Disability Living Allowance will undergo medical re-assessment using the new criteria

- Changes to council tax benefit (yet to be announced)

October 2013

- New benefit claimants of working age must claim Universal Credit

April 2014

- Existing 'working age' benefit claims will be converted to Universal Credit on a phased basis

  This will start with those claimants in part time work and those with temporary/agency work

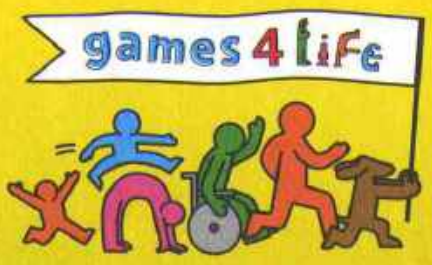
October 2014

- New claimants at Pension Credit age will not get housing benefit, instead their housing costs will be included in their pension credit

April 2016

- Remaining 'working age' benefit claimants will be converted to Universal Credit

GET SPORTY THIS SUMMER!



With all the exciting sporting activities taking place this summer, there hasn't been a better time to start a new healthy lifestyle.

To make things easier for you check out www.nhs.uk/change4life. It has lots of information about staying active and eating healthily packed onto its pages.

To discover more call 0300 123 4567 or find Change4Life on Facebook and Twitter.

YOU CAN...

- Receive a free personalised activity plan
- Search healthy and low cost recipes
- Sign up for money saving offers
- Find activities in your local area
- Download the fun generator app, which provides over 100 free, entertaining indoor and outdoor activity ideas for groups of all sizes.



THE LONDON PLEASURE GARDENS ARE NOW OPEN!

In the heart of the Olympic East End, London Pleasure Gardens is a major new 35,000 capacity arts and entertainment destination, which opened last month.

The 20 acre riverside site near Pontoon Dock DLR features open-air concerts, dance and theatre arenas, historic and contemporary architecture, an urban nature reserve, a boutique hotel and a floating cocktail bar.

London Pleasure Gardens provides scope for both global and local audiences to experience world-class musical acts and DJs, circus and promenade performances, film screenings, visual art, community projects and family activities.

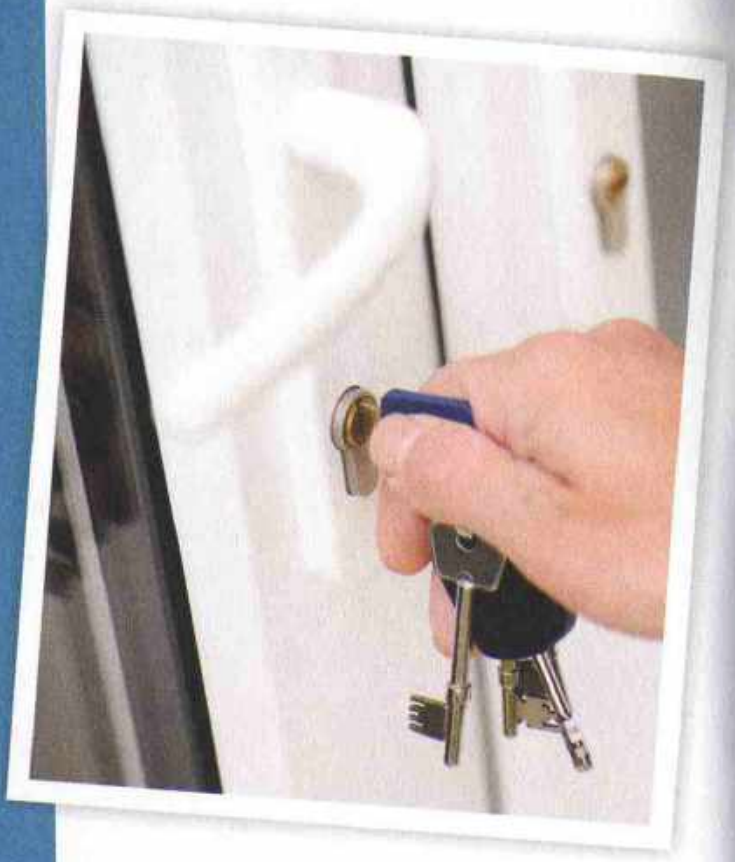
For more information visit www.londonpleasuregardens.com.

LIFT IT, LOCK IT

We all want to keep our home and belongings safe. Follow these simple tips to help make your property more secure:

- Close and lock all your doors and windows; even if you are only going out for a few minutes
- Double lock your door if possible. If you have a uPVC door lift the handle and lock it using the key
- Leave one or more lights on if it will be dark before you get home
- Make sure your valuables are stored securely and out of sight
- If you have a burglar alarm, ensure it works properly
- Lock your shed or garage and put away any tools
- If you are going on holiday ask someone you trust to keep an eye on your home

For more information about protecting your home call your local Safer Neighbourhoods Policing Team on 101 or visit **www.met.police.uk/crimeprevention**. In an emergency always call 999.



...We're Moving!

We are planning to open a new Resident Office in Thamesmead Town Centre later in the year. The new space is located at 15 Joyce Dawson Way (past Superdrug and next door to the Cafe).

Our current office in Titmuss Avenue will close to residents and most of our staff will be moved to Joyce Dawson Way. Team Gallions (our environmental team) will remain at Titmuss Avenue.

The new office will have:

- Three interview rooms
- Two booths for residents to report repairs by phone more privately
- A large reception space with child-friendly books and toys
- Free parking nearby

We will let you know nearer the time when the office will open. All the services at the new office will be the same as our current one.

the LINK

Opening this summer

The Link Thamesmead is a stunning new state-of-the-art community hub located under the Harrow Manor Way flyover in the heart of Thamesmead.

Aimed at young people but available to the whole community, The Link Thamesmead will be an exciting, safe and welcoming place offering a range of activities, facilities and opportunities, including...

- Indoor climbing wall
- High and low ropes courses
- Water sports
- Dance
- Drama
- Singing
- Bike workshops
- Fitness gym
- 200 seat performance studio
- Soundproof rehearsal room
- Recording studio
- Digital media suite
- Meeting rooms, an office and exhibition spaces for hire
- Volunteering opportunities
- Accredited and non-accredited courses

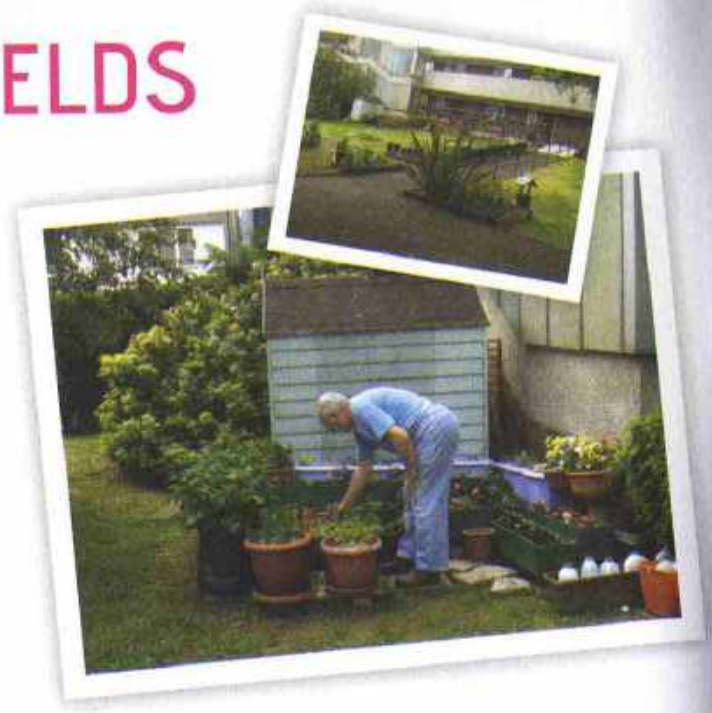
...And so much more!

Make your connection at: thelinkthamesmead.co.uk



ayplace
TRUST
THAMESMEAD

MEET THE CRANFIELDS



In this issue we meet Mr and Mrs Cranfield of Buckwheat Court, Thamesmead. The couple have lived in the area since 1975 and spend much of their time cultivating this beautiful communal garden in Buckwheat Court.

Can you tell us about the garden?

The Buckwheat Court communal garden is a great space that we have worked hard to improve. We carry out the gardening tasks with two other residents from the block on a voluntary basis. We designed the garden ourselves and now grow flowers and vegetables. We have produced delicious beans, peas, beetroot, parsnips, cabbage, potatoes and much more over the years.

What's your favourite part of the garden?

All of it! We spend as much time as we can keeping the garden looking good and we really enjoy it. We have some beautiful poppies in bloom at the moment.

Can other people get involved?

This garden is only for residents of Buckwheat Court but we would love to see more of our neighbours getting involved. If they are interested they can join us in the garden at any time.

What advice do you have for other residents?

Get together and talk to each other! If you can work on a communal garden or project together it's an excellent way to get to know your neighbours. Gardening is a great hobby too.

Thank you for the feedback...

Thank you to everyone that filled in our survey about this magazine back in April. We had almost 50 questionnaires returned and overall the feedback was excellent.

- 98 % of respondents regularly read Thamesview
- 95 % said it was easy to read
- 98 % said it was informative

Special thanks go to H Dowding and C Iloh of Thamesmead for their suggestions about featuring local history and careers information in Thamesview. We have included these ideas in this edition and we will continue to use your feedback to improve the magazine in future. Well done to Mr Bolarinwa of Garganey Walk, Thamesmead who was the winner of our survey prize draw.

If you have any feedback about the magazine or would like to help us edit it email us at thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk or call the Communications Team on 0300 123 1237.

WONDERFUL WEBSITE

Our website has recently been re-designed to make it easier to use. We hope that you've had the chance to use the new style site but if not, make sure you logon at www.gallionsha.co.uk today.

When you use our website you will also see a message asking you to let us place cookies (small pieces of data sent from a website) on your computer. We have done this because a new law asks us to.

At Gallions we use cookies to calculate visitor numbers and understand which pages are most popular on our website. This helps us make our website better and easier to use. We do not collect any personal data (name, address, telephone number and email address) via cookies.

For more information about our website contact the Communications Team at communications@gallionsha.co.uk or call 0300 123 1237.

On the website you can:

- Pay your rent
- Download a rent statement
- Report a repair
- Track communal repairs and those inside your home
- Read the latest news from Gallions
- Find out about events in your area





Our Teams

There are a number of different teams at Gallions that work with residents to improve our neighbourhoods and make sure we can deliver our services.

Neighbourhood Services Team

We have a team of Neighbourhood Services Officers and Neighbourhood Wardens who work together to deal with any issues in your area including:

- Tackling breaches of lease and tenancy
- Carrying out regular neighbourhood inspections
- Dealing with vandalism, abandoned vehicles, overgrown gardens, properties in poor condition
- Managing anti-social behaviour, harassment, domestic violence and hate crime
- Investigating sub-letting and tenancy fraud
- Working with local Police Safer Neighbourhood Teams as necessary



Zena Skinner
Neighbourhood Services Manager



Andy Howard
Enforcement Team Leader



Bho Thind
Anti-Social Behaviour Officer



Samanther Gibbs
Anti-Social Behaviour Officer

Parkview, Greenmead, Crayford, Erith and Belvedere...



Tamara Oros
Neighbourhood Services Officer



Frank Smith
Neighbourhood Warden

Moorings, Waterfield and Manorway...



Greg Smikle
Neighbourhood Services Officer



Phil Briggs
Neighbourhood Warden

Southmere, Lesnes and Abbey Wood...



Nathaniel Takyi-Berko
Neighbourhood Services Officer



Steve Hayzen
Neighbourhood Warden

Broadwaters, Woolwich, Crossways, Orpington and Sidcup...



Larry Lidbury
Neighbourhood Services Officer



Chris Waite
Neighbourhood Warden

Tower Hamlets, Newham, Lewisham and Lakeview Court...



Aaron Nicholson
Neighbourhood Services Officer



Chris Waite
Neighbourhood Warden

Revenue Management Team

The Revenue Management team is responsible for collecting income for all rented, leasehold and shared ownership properties. The team monitor rent accounts regularly to spot any problems early; they can then refer residents for a benefits health check or use best practice and legal procedures to recover funds and carry out evictions when necessary.

The team can give residents advice about paying their rent & service charges, benefits & tax credits, money management and more.

If you would like to contact any member of our team to discuss issues which are affecting you then please call us on **0300 123 1237**.

Dave Norris
Revenue Officer - Lesnes, Southmere, Crossway, Manorway



Carol Evans
Revenue Officer - Broadwaters, Newham, Sidcup, Tower Hamlets, Welling, Lewisham, Havering



Carol Grant
Revenue Officer - Abbey Wood, Belvedere, Crayford, Erith, Greenmead, Parkview, Plumstead, Woolwich



Janine Boyle
Shared Ownership, Rent To Home Buy, Intermediate Rent



Michael Smith
Leaseholders, Freeholders



Chika Amadi
Former tenant arrears



Derek Stainsby
Benefits advice



Mike Hemp
Benefits advice



Michael Day
Private let garages

Tina Mercer
Revenue Manager



Sike Adeshokan
Revenue Officer - Waterfield, Moorings



SCHOOL IS OUT...

FUN IS IN!

There are lots of activities for young people and their families in Thamesmead to take part in this summer so there's no reason for anyone to be bored. Trust Thamesmead's fabulous new community sports and leisure centre, Sporting Club Thamesmead, opens its doors soon and as part of the build-up to the official opening the Trust is organising a series of junior summer sports schools.

There's a choice of four different sports – golf, cricket, tennis and football – which will take place in Crossway Park (apart from the golf which is being hosted by our friends at Thamesview Golf Club).



Cricket Skill

30 Jul-3 Aug, 10am-3pm (8-13 year olds)

If you'd like to improve your cricketing skills this summer then this is just the course for you! It's a brand new five day course which will be run by qualified coaches.

Tennis Training

13-17 Aug, 10am-3pm (8-13 year olds)

Improve your tennis skills with this new five day course during the summer holidays which will be run by qualified coaches from Shooters Hill Tennis Club.

Football Course

20-24 Aug, 10am-3pm (5-13 year olds)

All sessions will be run by top coaches from Thamesmead Town Football Club and Charlton Athletic Community Trust.

All of the above courses, which must be booked in advance, cost just £39 per child, last five full days and are being run by qualified professionals who all have enhanced CRB checks and relevant first aid training. Spaces are limited so you must book in advance to avoid missing out.

Golf Tuition

6-8 Aug, 10am-1pm (8-12 year olds)

If you'd like to try your hand at golf we are offering a three day course for just £15, that's just £5 a day. There are a maximum of 30 spaces available and the course is open to boys and girls aged between 8-12 years old.

To check out dates and times visit **www.sportingclubthamesmead.co.uk** or call Dan Wells at Sporting Club Thamesmead on **020 8320 4470**.

OUR WORK WITH CHARLTON ATHLETIC COMMUNITY TRUST

GALLIONS IS THE PATRON FOR THE CHARLTON ATHLETIC COMMUNITY TRUST'S KICK START FOR LIFE SCHEME. THIS MEANS WE WORK WITH CHARLTON TO HELP PROMOTE HEALTHY LIVING WITHIN OUR COMMUNITIES.

This autumn we will be launching a cooking competition for year six pupils in primary schools across Thamesmead to help young people learn how to cook healthy meals. The first trial run will be at Linton Mead School in August. We are also promoting low cost and healthy recipes on our website if you would like some inspiration.

Charlton will also be running a range of sports courses for young people across London and Kent this summer. To find out more visit **www.cact.org.uk** or call 0871 781 2095.



DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

THE LEWISHAM BIG SCREEN

BLACKHEATH COMMON
27 July-12 August >> Free >> www.lewisham.gov.uk >> 020 8314 7321

BEXLEY ART GROUP ANNUAL EXHIBITION

FREEMANTLE HALL, BEXLEY
30 July-11 August >> 10am-6pm (10am-4pm on 5 August) >> Free
www.bexley.gov.uk >> 01322 430681

NATIONAL PLAY DAY

MANOR GARDENS (AT THE REAR OF LONDIS IN MANOR CLOSE), NORTH THAMESMEAD
7 August >> Free >> www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk >> 020 8320 4470

GREAT BRITISH BEER FESTIVAL

KENSINGTON OLYMPIA
7-11 August >> £8 per ticket >> www.gbbf.org.uk >> 020 7385 1200

FAMILY CARNIVAL

VENUE TO BE CONFIRMED, SOUTH THAMESMEAD
10 August >> Free >> www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk >> 020 8320 4470

ARTS AND CRAFTS

BIRCHMERE PARK, THAMESMEAD
16 August >> Free >> www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk >> 020 8320 4470

CARNAVAL DEL PUEBLO 2012

LONDON PLEASURE GARDENS, NEWHAM
19 August >> Free >> www.carnavaldelpueblo.co.uk >> 020 7928 4277

THAMES FESTIVAL 2012

BETWEEN WESTMINISTER BRIDGE & TOWER BRIDGE
8-9 September >> Free >> www.timeout.com/thamesfest >> 020 7928 8998

OPEN HOUSE LONDON 2012

THROUGHOUT LONDON
22-23 September >> Free >> www.londonopenhouse.org

WIN WITH OUR WORDSEARCH

In this wordsearch we have hidden the names of six famous oceans and seas around the world. Find them all and you could win a £30 shopping voucher.

PACIFIC ✓ ✓ ARCTIC

ATLANTIC ✓ ✓ SOUTHERN

INDIAN ✓ ✓ BALTIC

Z	X	C	V	B	N	M	A	S	D	F	G	H
J	K	L	Q	W	E	R	T	Y	U	I	O	P
E	D	C	R	F	C	I	C	T	H	U	J	M
O	K	L	U	J	H	I	I	B	G	T	V	F
M	L	P	O	J	N	W	T	E	R	T	Y	U
I	O	P	A	D	S	A	C	N	P	S	A	G
H	J	K	I	N	B	V	R	C	A	D	E	T
Y	U	A	K	L	O	E	A	P	C	L	Z	X
I	N	K	J	Y	H	D	T	T	I	R	T	B
O	B	A	L	T	I	C	J	T	F	O	L	A
P	L	I	U	A	S	A	E	R	I	N	K	M
P	A	O	S	C	V	B	N	M	C	I	R	O
L	S	A	S	D	F	G	H	J	K	L	P	N

DID YOU KNOW...

Water covers more than 70 percent of the Earth's surface, with the largest body of water, the Pacific Ocean, taking up more than one third of the planet's surface. The Pacific Ocean is the oldest ocean in the world and has existed for approximately 4 billion years.

Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Communications Team, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 31 Aug 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Name:

Address:

Telephone:

Email:

CONGRATULATIONS ...to Mistura of Secourt Road, Thamesmead who was the winner of our last wordsearch competition!

Summer is now in full swing and it promises to be an exciting time all round. With the Olympics upon us the GRG hopes to share similar successes wrapping up our first year as a scrutiny panel. We hope you all have a great time whatever you do, whatever the weather!

Time to tweet!

Gallions is now on twitter - which is great news for all those of you that love to tweet. Not only is it a move with the times, twitter is also an up to date and immediate information stream for all those with smartphones, computers or tablets. If you are looking for a local event, news on what's happening in your area or if you're looking for work, twitter is the place.

To get the best from twitter, why not register, follow your favourites and get involved in the conversation.

To visit Gallions' twitter page log onto www.twitter.com/gallionsha or type @gallionsha in the twitter search engine once you've logged on.

Let's get trending in UK!

#gallionshaisthebest

Getting back into work; help available...

The number of people currently unemployed in the UK is quite high, but nonetheless there are still jobs out there. The question is how can you grab those available opportunities? Some of you may find it difficult returning to work especially after long periods of unemployment. Your confidence might be low or you might need re-training but don't know who to turn to. Well help is at hand; there are a number of organisations out there providing all kinds of support to the unemployed. Take a look at the websites below – although this is only a snapshot, there are others, so you may want to do your own research too:

- **www.eastlondonworks.com** (check out the 'Jobs' and 'Help and Advice' sections to start with)
- **www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk/building_futures.cfm**
- **www.bexley.gov.uk** (type 'jobs and careers' in the search field to access lots of useful information)



You can also phone some of these organisations but they may well ask you to logon to the internet because of the volume of information available. Here are some phone numbers:

Bexley Council: **020 8303 7777**
Trust Thamesmead: **020 8320 4470**

Tenants view...

Thamesmead Surfers launch healthy eating recipe book

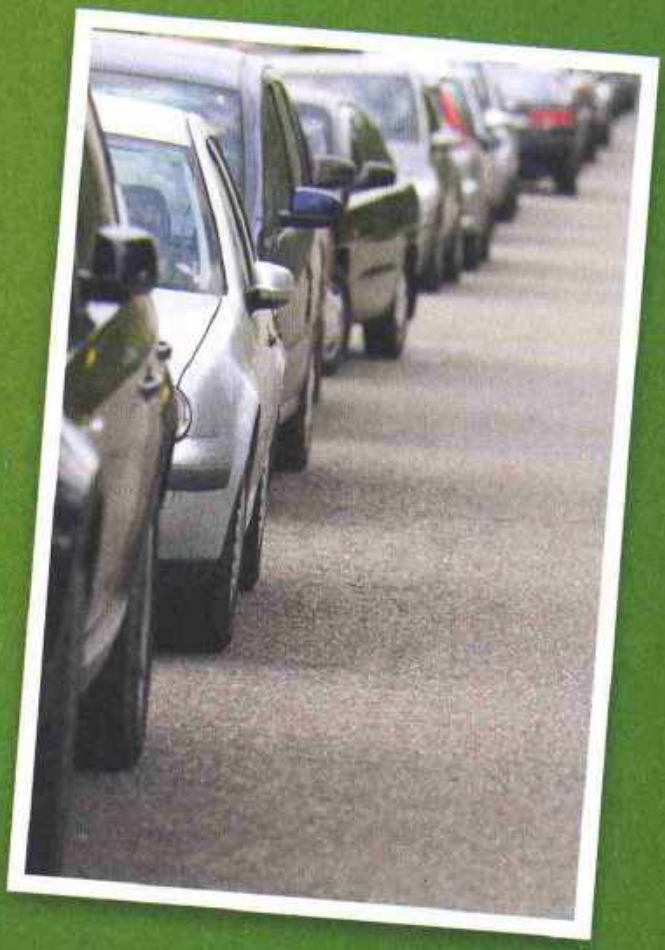
Last year Thamesmead Surfers, a local group for older people that aims to build confidence and morale, grabbed £500 from GRG to help fund a healthy eating recipe book - which has now been published. To celebrate the launch, the group held a 'mad hatter's tea party' at Fossett Lodge, Barnehurst. Cherry Kent went along as the GRG representative and thoroughly enjoyed the afternoon.

If you're over 50 years old, live in Thamesmead and would like to find out more about the group or to join, get in touch with Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237. You can also contact Helen if you're interested in getting a copy of the recipe booklet.

Parking your car: please consider others...

Finding a car parking space in London can sometimes be a challenge. If you happen to have a designated bay for your vehicle, then consider yourself lucky. With an excessive number of cars and a lack of parking spaces, we all need to be a bit more considerate and think about others when we park. Here are a few tips that will go towards helping us do just that:

- Only park in designated bays
- Don't block people in
- Don't block fire escapes or emergency exits
- Be polite



Not insuring your vehicle could be costly...

If you're the registered keeper of a vehicle you must make sure it's insured; unless you meet any of the following exceptions:

- If you have made a SORN (Statutory Off Road Notification) for the vehicle
- If your vehicle has been kept off-road since before SORN came into force on 31 January 1998 – unless it was brought back into use
- If your vehicle is recorded as stolen, passed or sold to the motor trade or between registered keepers
- If your vehicle is recorded scrapped or permanently exported by the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency (DVLA)

Failing to insure your vehicle (if you do not meet any of the above exceptions) could:

- Lead to a fixed penalty of £100
- Lead to your vehicle being wheel-clamped, impounded, or destroyed
- Lead to court prosecution, with a possible maximum fine of £1000

So to avoid any action please make sure you have adequate insurance.

Spotlight on Newham

Newham is situated just a few miles east of the City of London, and north of the River Thames. It is one of the six host boroughs for the 2012 Summer Olympics.

Historically, Newham was formed by merging the former area of the Essex County Borough of East Ham and the County Borough of West Ham on 1 April 1965. It is one of only 16 councils in the UK with a directly elected mayor – a post currently held by Sir Robin Wales.

Newham has the highest young population in the country according to the 2001 Census. It is also one of the most diverse areas with a good mix of white British, Asian, African, Caribbean and Chinese inhabitants.

Some interesting facts...

Population trend throughout the ages:

1801 >> 8,875
1901 >> 338,506
2001 >> 243,737

Some famous people from the area:

Singer: David Essex
Actor: Terence Stamp
Photographer: David Bailey
Athlete: Christine Ohuruogu
Footballer: Jermain Defoe

Tenants view...

Another great recipe...



Plum and Frangipane Tart

Why not enjoy this yummy treat with friends and family this summer. If plum isn't your favourite fruit, you can always replace it with something you really like. This treat also works well with cherries, apricots, apples or pears.

Preparation: 30 mins (plus 30 mins refrigeration time)

Cooking time: 20-25 mins

Makes: 8 slices

INGREDIENTS

Pastry:
- 7 oz plain flour,
- 2 tbsp icing sugar,
- 3.5 oz butter,
- 6 large plums cut into 8ths,
- Flaked almonds to decorate.

Frangipane:
- 3.5 oz sugar,
- 3.5 oz butter,
- 2 eggs,
- 3.5 oz ground almonds,
- 1 tbsp self raising flour,
- 2 tbsp apricot jam.

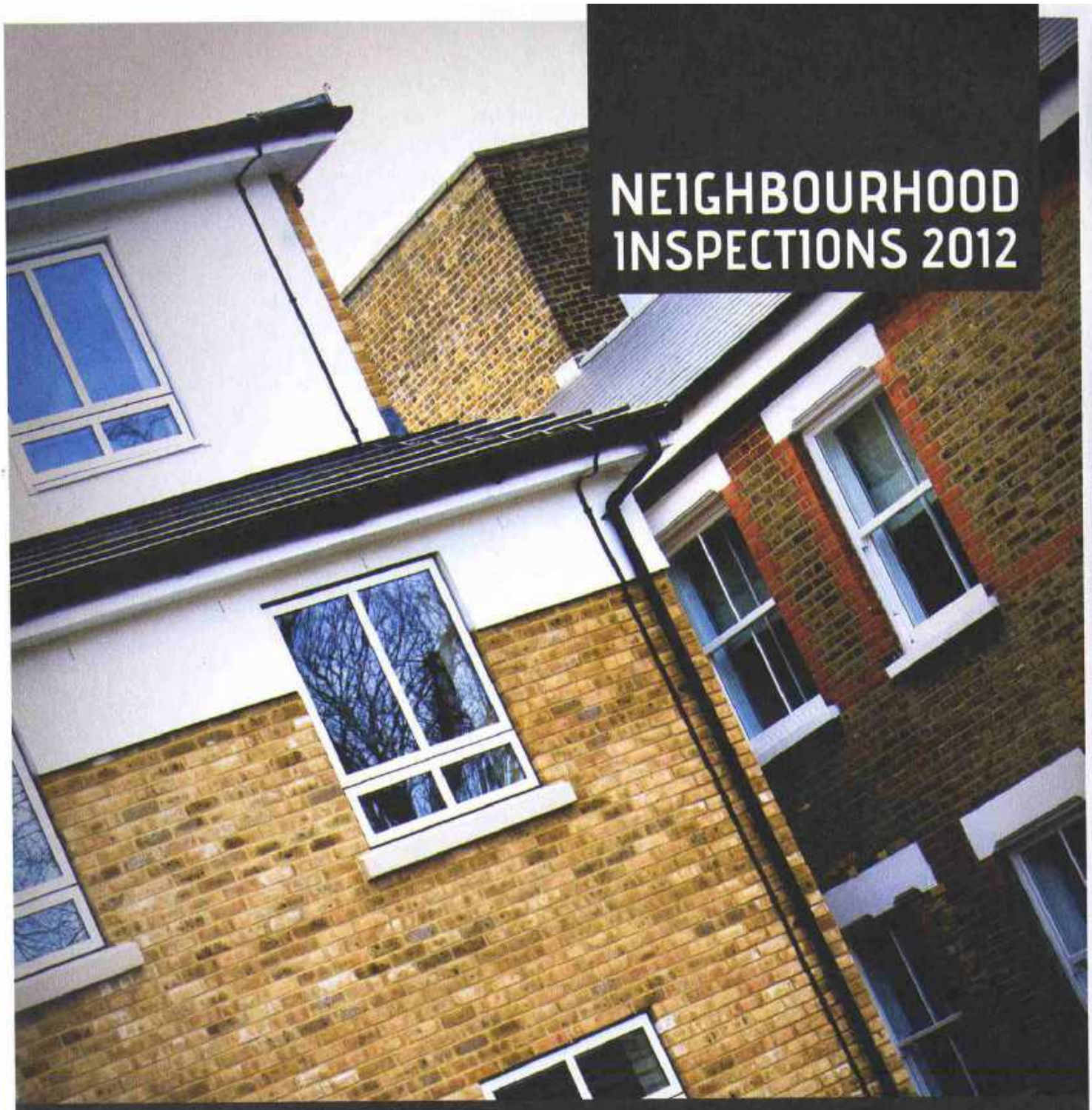
METHOD

THE PASTRY...

1. Mix together the flour, icing sugar and butter until they resemble breadcrumbs.
2. Add enough water to bring together into a dough.
3. Roll out between two sheets of cling film.
4. Press pastry into an oiled 9"/23cm flan dish.
5. Refrigerate for 30 minutes (this stops the pastry shrinking when baking).
6. Place a circle of parchment paper over the raw pastry.
7. Cover the paper with ceramic baking beans.
8. Bake in a pre-heated 160°C (Fan)/180° oven for about 20 Minutes.
9. Remove paper and beans.
10. Spread with Apricot Jam.

THE FRANGIPANE...

1. Beat the butter and sugar until light and fluffy.
2. Beat in the eggs.
3. Mix in the ground almonds and flour.
4. Pour into the cooked pastry case.
5. Arrange the plum slices on top.
6. Bake in a preheated oven for about 25 minutes.
7. When cool scatter with flaked almonds.



NEIGHBOURHOOD INSPECTIONS 2012

Join our Neighbourhood Services Officers at the next Neighbourhood Inspection near you! You will be able to discuss issues in your area including:

- Graffiti
- Littering
- Dog fouling
- Unmaintained gardens
- Abandoned vehicles

If your neighbourhood isn't listed here but you'd like the Neighbourhood Services Officers to visit, call us on **0300 123 1237**. If you live in a flat your caretaker will inspect the areas inside your block – just chat to them if you have any issues.

BROADWATERS

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Larry Lidbury
Warden: Chris Waite

- 28 Aug 2012
- 16 Oct 2012
- 27 Nov 2012

Meet at the junction between Whinchat Road and Wigeon Path at 2:00pm

CRAYFORD

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Tamara Oros
Warden: Frank Smith

- 26 July 2012
- 6 Sep 2012
- 18 Oct 2012
- 6 Dec 2012

Contact us if you would like to attend and we will agree a meeting place at 2:00pm

CROSSWAYS

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Larry Lidbury
Warden: Chris Waite

- 2 Oct 2012

Contact us if you would like to attend and we will agree a meeting place at 2:00pm

GREENMEAD

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Tamara Oros
Warden: Frank Smith

- 13 Sep 2012
- 15 Nov 2012

Meet in Lime Row outside the Post Office at 2:00pm

LESNES

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Nathaniel Takyi-Berko
Warden: Steve Hayzen

- 9 Aug 2012
- 8 Nov 2012

Outside Radley House (Wolvercote Road) at 2:00pm

LEWISHAM

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Aaron Nicholson
Warden: Chris Waite

- 16 Aug 2012
- 15 Nov 2012

Phoenix Works, main entrance, 10:00-11:00am

Lewisham Way, main entrance, 11:30am-12:30pm

MANORWAY

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Greg Smikle
Warden: Phil Briggs

- 4 Sep 2012
- 4 Dec 2012

Meet at the junction between Goldcrest Close and Whimbrel Close at 2:00pm

MOORINGS

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Greg Smikle
Warden: Phil Briggs

- 14 Aug 2012
- 2 Oct 2012
- 13 Nov 2012

Meet at the junction between Titmuss Avenue and Booth Close at 2:00pm

NEWHAM

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Aaron Nicholson
Warden: Chris Waite

- 2 Aug 2012
- 1 Nov 2012

Little Ilford, meet at Churcher House, 10:00am-12:00pm

Barrier Park, meet at Estuary House, 13:00-15:00pm

OLD CHURCH COURT: NORTH END ROAD & BALTIMORE CLOSE

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Tamara Oros
Warden: Frank Smith

- 23 Aug 2012
- 22 Nov 2012

For Old Church Court meet by the entry gate to the car park at 2:00pm

For North End Road and Baltimore Close call us if you would like to attend and we will agree a meeting place

PARKVIEW

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Tamara Oros
Warden: Frank Smith

- 25 Oct 2012

Outside Timothy House (Kale Road) at 2:00pm

SOUTHMERE

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Nathaniel Takyi-Berko
Warden: Steve Hayzen

- 30 Aug 2012
- 29 Nov 2012

Meet at the junction between Hartslock Drive and Portmeadow Walk at 2:00pm

ST JOSEPHS

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Nathaniel Takyi-Berko
Warden: Frank Smith

- 20 Sep 2012
- 13 Dec 2012

Meet in the car park at 2:00pm

TOWER HAMLETS

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Aaron Nicholson
Warden: Chris Waite

- 31 Aug 2012
- 30 Nov 2012

Millharbour, main entrance, 10:30am-12:00pm

Carnell Apartments, main entrance, 12:30-13:30pm

Gloster Ridley Court, main entrance, 13:30-14:00pm

Limehouse Basin, main courtyard, 14:15-15:00pm

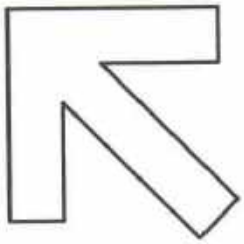
Carmine Wharf main entrance, 15:30-16:00pm

WATERFIELD

Neighbourhood Services
Officer: Greg Smikle
Warden: Phil Briggs

- 21 Aug 2012
- 9 Oct 2012
- 20 Nov 2012

Meet at junction between Byron Close and Owen Close at 2:00pm



SUB-LETTING UPDATE

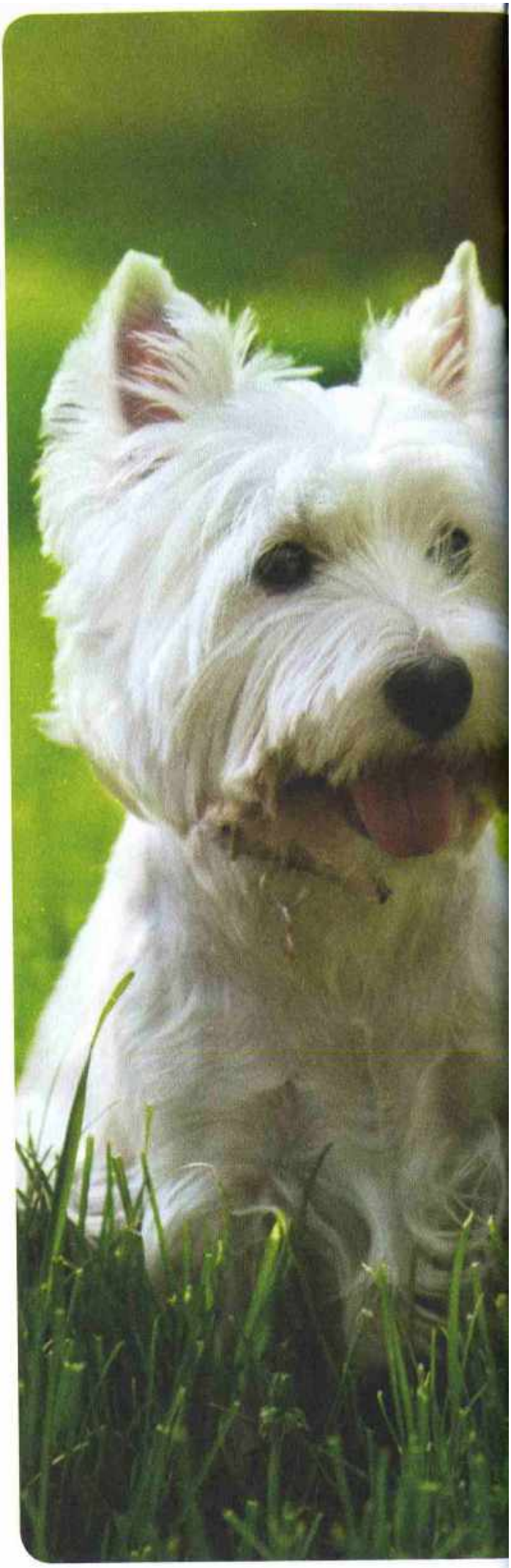
Many thanks to all residents that have told us about their suspicions of tenancy fraud and unlawful sub-lets. When you tell us about a property you suspect is being sub-let we start an investigation, but we keep all your information confidential and do not give it to anyone else.

Tenancy fraud prevents those that need social housing the most from having access to it. Since 2010 Gallions have recovered 121 properties and without your help we would not have achieved this.

There are a number of ways to spot if someone in your community is a housing cheat. Look out for:

- Different tenants moving in and out of a property on a regular basis
- Someone collecting rent from your neighbours
- Many more people living in a property than before

Please report your suspicions. Chat to staff at our office, fill in a form on our website at **www.gallionsha.co.uk**, or give us a call us on **0300 123 1237**.



LOOKING AFTER YOUR NEIGHBOURHOOD

HELP US KEEP YOUR STREETS CLEAN AND PREVENT DOG FOULING BY REPORTING OWNERS WHO FAIL TO CLEAN UP AFTER THEIR PETS.

If there is a dog fouling problem in your neighbourhood please let us know so we can look into it. You can contact us on **0300 123 1237**, visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or speak to a member of staff. Often our Neighbourhood Wardens will be able to patrol the area but they need information to help them target their patrols. So when you make a report please tell us:

- The days of the week when offences are taking place
- The time that offences are taking place
- Where the offences happen
- A description of the owner
- A description of the dog
- If the owner is using a car, the vehicle registration number

Some don'ts...

- Let your dog foul on your balcony
- Wash dog mess into balcony drains
- Risk a Fixed Penalty Notice fine by not cleaning up after your dog
- Forget to let us know you intend to keep a dog

Some do's...

- Walk your dog regularly and always clear up after your pet
- Where possible dispose of dog mess in a designated dog waste bin
- If you can't find a dog waste bin, bag your pet's mess and take it home for disposal
- If no other option is available pick up any mess and seal it well using a bag which can then be carefully placed in a standard public litter bin

ARE YOU A NOISY NEIGHBOUR?

We receive more reports about noise nuisance than any other type of anti-social behaviour so we have put this guide together to help you deal with noise issues.

- Noise nuisance includes: loud music or TVs, doors banging, arguing, shouting and dogs barking continuously
- Often the best way for you to deal with a noisy neighbour is to talk to them about the problem calmly and try to find a good outcome for both of you
- If you have spoken to your neighbour and the noise continues then please contact us. We can write to your neighbour formally, to let them know that they are in breach of their tenancy and to ask them to reduce the level of noise immediately. If the noise continues we may be able to take legal action to stop the noise, but to do this, we will require evidence of the problem and how it has affected you
- Alternatively, we can install noise monitoring equipment in your home to record noise levels and establish whether it is reasonable. This may be used as evidence for legal action
- We can also refer you to a local, free and confidential mediation service where you will be supported to resolve the disagreement with your neighbour
- You can contact your local council who may undertake an assessment of the noise nuisance and could possibly serve an abatement notice on your neighbour to limit the noisy activities



Noise nuisance can be very distressing, especially if it's persistent. Try to keep noise to a minimum and be sure that it stops at an acceptable time. If you are asked to reduce the noise please be reasonable and consider how it is impacting on others.

There are a number of ways you can report anti-social behaviour including noise nuisance:

- Call us on **0300 123 1237**
- Fill in the anti-social behaviour reporting form on our website
- Visit our Residents Office
- Tell a Warden or your Neighbourhood Services Officer

STAYING IN TOUCH



Our phone lines are open Monday to Friday, from 8am until 6pm.

An emergency service runs at all other times, including weekends and bank holidays.

Please make sure you call the correct team to deal with your query using the following guide...

Customer Contact Team >> 0300 123 1237

- Applying for housing or a transfer
- Paying your rent
- Benefits advice
- Rubbish disposal and cleaning
- Getting involved with Gallions
- Complaints, comments or compliments
- Disability aids and adaptations
- Planned home improvements
- Making your own home improvements
- Advice about condensation or damp
- Reporting anti-social behaviour
- Changing or ending your tenancy
- Contents insurance
- Renting a garage
- Anything else!

Repairs Contact Team >> 0300 123 1238

- Report a repair
- Get an update about a repair

Gas Servicing Team >> 020 8300 0300

- Gas boiler servicing
- Repairs to central heating systems

How well are we doing?

This performance chart shows our performance as a landlord during the 2012 financial year compared to 2011.

If you would like to join our residents group and help us monitor and improve what we do please contact Helen Chambers on 0300 123 1237.

Description	2011/12	2012/13	Target	Performance Trend	Current Status
Overall satisfaction with service	82%	82%	75%	◄ ►	
Void re-let period (a lower figure is better)	21 Days	24 Days	25 Days	▼	
Emergency repairs completed within timescale	99%	98%	97%	▼	
Calls answered within 20 seconds (Customer Contact Team)	88%	94%	80%	▲	
Calls answered within 20 seconds (Repairs Contact Team)	78%	82%	80%	▲	
Complaints answered within timescale	98%	97%	90%	▼	
Satisfaction with anti-social behaviour process	90%	83%	70%	▼	
Rent collected	96%	97.5%	99.5%	▲	

Overall Performance Trend	
Better than last year	▲
Worse than last year	▼
The same as last year	◄ ►

Performance Status	
Above Target	
Below Target	

HOMEOWNER NEWS

Tenants and Residents Associations (TRAs)

A Tenants and Residents Association is a group of people who live in an area or a block who decide that they want to get together to deal with issues in their area, including anti social behaviour, a lack of facilities, dissatisfaction with services, wanting to build a sense of community.
The group can include tenants, shared owners and leaseholders.

A formal residents association has:

- Agreed to represent and be accountable to residents in a certain location
- A constitution
- An elected committee which includes a chair, secretary, and treasurer; and could include others, like a vice chair and social secretary
- Opened a bank account in the name of the group with at least two signatories not from the same family
- An equal opportunities policy or statement

Here we interview Alexandra from Schoolhouse Yard Residents Association:

Q: What is your position at the Residents Association?

I'm the Secretary of the association. There are 3 blocks on our site and I'm the rep for Block A as well. I've been a member since it was founded almost three years ago.

Q: What does your role involve?

As the Secretary I'm in charge of taking and typing up minutes for our meetings and managing our email account. As the rep for Block A, I put notices up for upcoming meetings and I'm available for residents if they have questions or concerns they want us to raise with Gallions on their behalf.

Q: Why did you join the Residents Association?

Corine Meier, another resident at Schoolhouse Yard, set up the Residents Association. She convinced me and the other committee members that it would be the most effective way to liaise with Gallions and Remus (our managing agent) and make improvements where we live.

Q: What are the benefits of a Residents Association?

The rewards can be tremendous. In our first year, we asked Gallions to improve the format and the information provided on our service charge estimates and actuals. That was looked at along with the insurance for our blocks and some issues with the lift and the intercom. Overall, home owners were reimbursed more than £19,000 between them.

Q: Would you recommend setting up a Resident Association to other residents?

Definitely, it is hard work but it is worth it. There are the obvious financial rewards but it also allowed us to create a community of neighbours who know and can rely on each other. We hold social events regularly where all residents can get together. I am so grateful to Corine for creating the group, and thanks to her, neighbours went from being strangers to friendly acquaintances or even dear friends and in London, that's a priceless luxury.

If you would like to start your own Tenant or Residents Association talk to your neighbours and encourage them to get involved. You should also call our Resident Engagement Team on 0300 123 1237 for advice and information.

Gallions Housing Association

• NOTICEBOARD •

IMPROVEMENTS IN SOUTH THAMESMEAD

We are hoping to make more changes in the area in future to make it a better place to live. There will be a consultation roadshow this summer that will give residents lots of information about the future plans for South Thamesmead and the opportunity to share their views.

Why not join us...

Limestone Hall
Thursday 19 July, 1-7pm

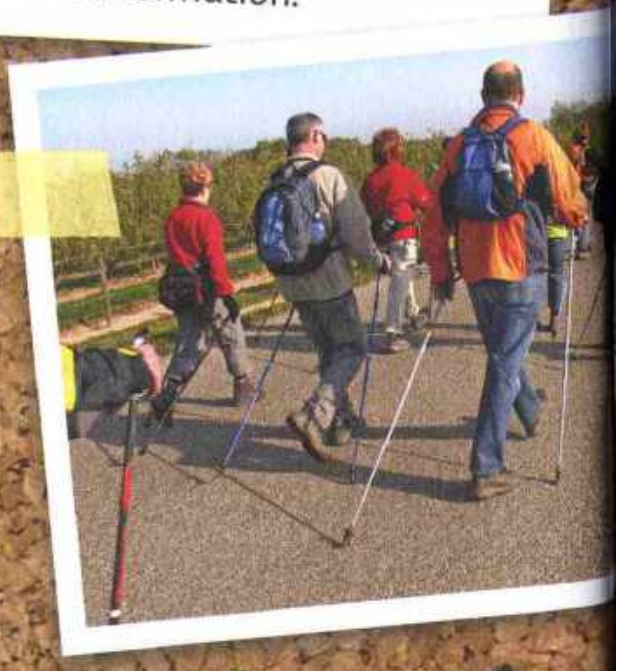
Tavy Bridge Library
Saturday 28 July, 10am-1pm

Limestone Hall
Friday 10 August, 11am-3pm

GREENWICH HEALTHY LIVING SERVICE

If you live in the London Borough of Greenwich make sure you check out greenwichhealthyliving.nhs.uk. It's packed full of information about free and fun courses in your area; from Tai Chi and Nordic walking to cookery classes and a stop smoking group... ...there's something for everyone.

You can also call 0800 587 5833 for more information.



NEW WAYS TO PAY



You can now pay your rent by text or by app. Registration is quick and simple and once you have signed up you can make payments on the go 24 hours a day, seven days a week. There's less paperwork for you to worry about too. You can still use all the normal payment methods like Direct Debit, PayPoint, online or over the phone.

For full instructions visit **www.gallionsha.co.uk/rent** or call us on **0300 123 1237**.









YOU SAID, WE DID!

Mr Rugg of Waterfield, Thamesmead contacted us to let us know that rubbish had been dumped in the street near his home. Team Gallions were able to respond to his report and clear the rubbish, which included furniture and glass within 24 hours.

Mr Rugg was very pleased with the service and praised Team Gallions for their excellent work. If you spot a problem where you live, let us know straightaway so we can do something about it. Call us on **0300 123 1237** or report it online.

Kidsview WORDSEARCH

Summer is finally here! We have hidden six things you might find on a beach. Find them all and you could win a family cinema ticket...



P	L	S	E	A	S	H	E	L	L	O	K	I
J	U	H	Y	G	U	T	F	R	D	E	S	W
A	Q	M	N	B	R	V	C	X	Z	A	P	L
O	K	M	I	J	F	N	U	H	B	Y	G	V
T	F	C	R	D	B	X	E	S	Z	W	A	Q
P	L	O	K	D	O	M	I	F	J	N	U	H
B	Y	B	N	G	A	V	T	I	F	C	R	D
X	E	A	S	Z	R	W	A	S	Q	P	L	M
O	S	R	O	K	D	I	J	H	E	N	U	H
B	Y	C	G	V	T	F	C	R	D	V	X	E
S	Z	W	A	P	L	O	K	M	I	J	A	N
U	H	A	S	D	F	G	H	J	K	L	E	W
Z	C	V	B	N	M	O	U	J	T	F	R	O

SAND • SEASHELL • WAVES

FISH • SURFBOARD • CRAB

This competition is just for kids under the age of 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Communications Team, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost RSLT-LYEG-HZAL, PO Box 268, Sidcup, DA15 0FB or drop it into our reception by 31st August 2012. The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name:

Parent's name:

Address:

Telephone:

WELL DONE ...to Sushant of Springate House, Newham who was the winner of our last competition!